

UPSC Practice Exam — Mixed GS + CSAT

Date: 21 June 2026 | Maximum Marks: 165 | Time: 2 Hours

Topics: ['Current Affairs (June 13-20, 2026)', 'Anti-Defection Law', 'Harappan Civilization', 'Vedic Age', 'Jainism & Buddhism', 'Mahajanapadas & Magadha', 'WPI/CPI/PPI', 'IBC 2016', 'FDI Insurance', 'Climatology', 'Renewable Energy Grid', 'India-Japan JCM', 'Iran-US Deal', 'Nipah Virus', 'Telegram Ban 69A', 'Mekedatu Dam']

INSTRUCTIONS:

- All questions are compulsory in Section A (MCQ).
- Marking: +2 for correct, -0.66 for wrong, 0 for unattempted (MCQ only).
- Section B: Attempt ONE out of two 10-mark questions.
- Section C: Attempt ONE out of two 20-mark questions.
- Section D: Attempt ONE out of two essay topics (1000-1200 words).
- Use of calculator or electronic devices is NOT permitted.
- Write answers in the space/sheets provided. Use diagrams where appropriate.

SECTION A-1: CONCEPTUAL MCQs (10 x 2 = 20 marks | +2 correct, -0.66 wrong)

Select the most appropriate option.

■ Static & Book-Based (History, Polity, Economy, Geography)

Q1. Consider the following statements about the Harappan Civilization:

1. The citadel was generally located to the west of the lower town.
2. The Harappan script has been deciphered and is classified as Proto-Dravidian.
3. Burnt bricks were used extensively in Harappan construction, unlike contemporary Mesopotamian cities.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 3 only | (b) 2 and 3 only |
| (c) 1 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

Q2. With reference to the Vedic Age, which of the following is/are correctly matched?

1. Rig Vedic society - Predominantly pastoral and tribal
2. Painted Grey Ware - Associated with Later Vedic culture
3. Ashvamedha - Horse sacrifice performed in Rig Vedic period

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 2 and 3 only |
| (c) 1 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

Q3. Which of the following factors contributed to the rise of Magadha as the most powerful Mahajanapada?

1. Availability of iron ore in the region
2. Strategic location on the Ganga enabling trade and transport
3. Access to war elephants from neighbouring forests
4. Early adoption of republican form of governance

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- | | |
|---------------------|---------------------|
| (a) 1, 2 and 3 only | (b) 2, 3 and 4 only |
| (c) 1 and 4 only | (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4 |

Q4. Consider the following statements about Jainism:

1. The three jewels (Triratna) of Jainism are Right Knowledge, Right Faith, and Right Action.
2. Mahavira added the doctrine of Brahmacharya (continence) as the fifth vow to the teachings of Parshvanath.
3. Jainism prohibited agriculture because it involves killing of living beings.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 1 and 3 only |
| (c) 2 and 3 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

Q5. With reference to the Anti-Defection Law (Tenth Schedule), consider the following statements:

1. The 52nd Amendment Act of 1985 introduced the Tenth Schedule.
2. The 91st Amendment Act of 2003 deleted the provision exempting splits from disqualification.
3. The question of disqualification is decided by the President of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 1 and 3 only |
| (c) 2 and 3 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

Q6. The Wholesale Price Index (WPI) in India:

1. measures inflation at the macro-level for policymaking.
2. is published by the Office of the Economic Adviser, Ministry of Commerce and Industry.
3. includes services sector prices in its basket.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 1 and 3 only |
| (c) 2 and 3 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

Q7. With reference to FDI in India's insurance sector, which of the following represents the correct chronological progression of the FDI limit?

- | | |
|----------------------------|----------------------|
| (a) 26% - 49% - 74% - 100% | (b) 26% - 49% - 100% |
| (c) 49% - 74% - 100% | (d) 26% - 74% - 100% |

Q8. Consider the following about the Eightfold Path (Astangika Marga) of Buddhism:

1. It includes Right Livelihood and Right Memory.
2. It was first preached at the Deer Park in Sarnath near Varanasi.
3. It is meant to eliminate dependence on priestly rituals for salvation.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 2 and 3 only |
| (c) 1 and 3 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

Q9. Which of the following is NOT a characteristic feature of trade winds?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (a) They blow from subtropical high-pressure belts toward the equatorial low. | (b) They are deflected to the right in the Northern Hemisphere due to Coriolis force. |
| (c) They are associated with constant procession of temperate cyclones. | (d) They blow with great regularity and consistency throughout the year. |

Q10. The Producer Price Index (PPI) differs from the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) in that:

1. PPI measures prices at the producer/factory gate, not at the wholesale market.
2. PPI can track price changes at primary and intermediate stages before reaching finished goods.
3. PPI includes transport costs and trade margins, unlike WPI.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 2 and 3 only |
| (c) 1 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

SECTION A-2: CURRENT AFFAIRS MCQs (20 x 2 = 40 marks | +2 correct, -0.66 wrong)

Select the most appropriate option.

■ Current Affairs (June 13-20, 2026)

Q11. With reference to the Anti-Defection Law and recent political developments (June 2026), consider the following statements:

1. Under Paragraph 4 of the Tenth Schedule, a merger requires at least two-thirds of the members of the original political party in the legislature to agree.
2. The 91st Amendment of 2003 removed the exemption for 'splits' but retained the provision for 'mergers'.
3. The NDA alliance in 2026 is approaching the two-thirds majority required for constitutional amendments.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

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|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 2 and 3 only |
| (c) 1, 2 and 3 | (d) 1 only |

Q12. With reference to the Delhi High Court's June 2026 ruling on the Telegram ban under Section 69A of the IT Act, which is/are correct?

1. The court ruled that 'information' under S.69A includes software platforms, not just content.
2. Section 66A of the IT Act was used as a supplementary provision to justify the ban.
3. The ban was imposed in the context of NEET-UG examination paper leaks.

Select the correct answer using the code below:

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|------------------|----------------|
| (a) 1 and 3 only | (b) 1, 2 and 3 |
| (c) 2 and 3 only | (d) 1 only |

Q13. Regarding the Iran-US agreement signed in June 2026, consider the following:

1. Iran has pledged to dilute its highly enriched uranium (HEU) under IAEA supervision.
2. Pakistan and Qatar served as mediators during the negotiation process.
3. The agreement includes a \$300 billion economic development plan for Iran.
4. Israel is a signatory to the agreement.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|---------------------|-------------------|
| (a) 1, 2 and 3 only | (b) 1 and 2 only |
| (c) 1, 3 and 4 only | (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4 |

Q14. With reference to the India-Japan Joint Crediting Mechanism (JCM) operationalized in June 2026, which is/are correct?

1. It operates under Article 6.2 of the Paris Agreement.
2. It enables transfer of Internationally Transferred Mitigation Outcomes (ITMOs).
3. Projects under JCM are overseen by a bilateral Joint Committee formed by both governments.

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 2 and 3 only |
| (c) 1 and 3 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

Q15. Consider the following statements about Nipah Virus outbreaks in India:

1. The 2026 Kozhikode outbreak is the sixth Nipah outbreak in Kerala.
2. Nipah virus belongs to the family Paramyxoviridae and genus Henipavirus.
3. The natural reservoir of Nipah virus is the Pteropus genus of fruit bats.
4. The case fatality rate (CFR) of Nipah ranges from 40% to 75%.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|---------------------|---------------------|
| (a) 1, 2 and 3 only | (b) 2, 3 and 4 only |
| (c) 1, 3 and 4 only | (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4 |

Q16. With reference to India's renewable energy grid bottleneck (June 2026), consider the following:

1. Over 50 GW of renewable capacity is stranded due to transmission lag.
2. In FY2025, only about 58% of targeted new transmission lines were commissioned.
3. Rajasthan alone has approximately 8 GW of stranded renewable capacity.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 3 only

(b) 1 and 2 only

(c) 2 and 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q17. The Supreme Court of India in June 2026 expanded Article 21 to include the 'Right to Walk on Footpaths'. Consider the following:

1. Justice P.S. Narasimha authored the judgment.
2. The Court held that pedestrian rights take priority over motorised vehicles on footpaths.
3. The Court directed that the Street Vendors Act 2014 must be repealed to protect pedestrian rights.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 2 and 3 only

(c) 1 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q18. With reference to the Mekedatu Dam dispute (June 2026), consider the following:

1. The proposed dam is a balancing reservoir across the river Cauvery.
2. The Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal gave its final award in February 2007.
3. Tamil Nadu Assembly unanimously opposed the Karnataka project in June 2026.
4. Mekedatu dam has already received approval from the Central Water Commission.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only

(b) 1 and 3 only

(c) 2, 3 and 4 only

(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q19. Consider the following about India's IBC Amendment 2026:

1. It introduced the CIIRP (Corporate Insolvency and Interim Resolution Process) under Sections 54C-54P.
2. The amendment changed 'may' to 'shall' in Section 7(5)(a), making admission of applications mandatory.
3. This amendment overrides the Supreme Court's ruling in the Vidarbha Industries case.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 2 and 3 only

(c) 1 and 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q20. With reference to India's defence production in FY2025-26, which is/are correct?

1. Annual defence production reached an all-time high of Rs.1.78 lakh crore.
2. India's \$2 billion drone procurement focuses on attritable (low-cost, mass-produced) tactical systems.
3. The Defence Acquisition Procedure (DAP) promotes procurement of COTS items.

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 1 and 3 only |
| (c) 2 and 3 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

Q21. Regarding the Women's Reservation Act 2023 and the ADR analysis (June 2026):

1. Only 10.2% of candidates fielded across 20 states since 2023 have been women.
2. No party met the 33% benchmark for women candidates in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections.
3. The Act reserves 33% of seats in Lok Sabha and all State Legislative Assemblies for women.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 2 and 3 only |
| (c) 1 and 3 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

Q22. With reference to India's CPI inflation and PPI transition (June 2026), which is/are correct?

1. CPI inflation stood at 3.93% for the reported month.
2. India's new WPI has been revised with base year 2022-23 and covers 957 items.
3. India plans to completely phase out WPI by 2031 and replace it with PPI.

Select the correct answer:

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 1 and 3 only |
| (c) 2 and 3 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

Q23. Regarding the Naolekar Committee constituted in May 2026:

1. It was constituted by the Ministry of Home Affairs.
2. It is headed by Justice P.P. Naolekar with 6 members.
3. Its mandate is to study demographic changes and submit binding recommendations within one year.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|------------------|----------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 1, 2 and 3 |
| (c) 2 and 3 only | (d) 1 only |

Q24. Regarding the IRDAI FDI reform announced in 2026:

1. FDI in insurance is proposed to be raised to 100% from the current 74%.
2. The concept of 'composite license' would allow firms to offer both life and non-life insurance.
3. IRDAI was established under the IRDAI Act of 1999.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 3 only | (b) 2 and 3 only |
| (c) 1 and 2 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

Q25. India's monsoon deficit as of mid-June 2026 is reported at 35%. Consider the following:

1. The Long Period Average (LPA) for monsoon rainfall is calculated based on the period 1971-2020.
2. Central India recorded a deficit of 61% as of mid-June 2026.
3. IMD projected overall seasonal rainfall at 90% of LPA for 2026.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 1, 2 and 3

(c) 2 and 3 only

(d) 1 and 3 only

Q26. With reference to the India-France Innovation Roadmap 2030 (June 2026), which is/are correct?

1. UPI payment services were launched at Paris Airport during PM Modi's France visit.
2. SHANTI Act relates to Small Modular Reactors (SMR) in nuclear energy cooperation.
3. India-EU FTA negotiations were concluded and signed in February 2026.

Select the correct answer:

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 1 only

(c) 1, 2 and 3

(d) 2 and 3 only

Q27. Consider the following about the Ebola outbreak in DRC (2026):

1. The WHO declared it a Public Health Emergency of International Concern (PHEIC).
2. The strain involved is the Zaire ebolavirus.
3. The Ervebo (rVSV-ZEBOV) vaccine uses a ring vaccination strategy.
4. PHEIC declarations are made under the International Health Regulations (IHR) 2005.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only

(b) 2, 3 and 4 only

(c) 1, 2, 3 and 4

(d) 1 and 4 only

Q28. Regarding the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) developments in June 2026:

1. Madhya Pradesh is set to introduce a UCC Bill in the Monsoon Session (July 2026).
2. The UCC committee for MP is headed by Justice Ranjana Prasad Desai.
3. Uttarakhand, Gujarat, and Assam have already implemented UCC in their states.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 1, 2 and 3

(c) 1 and 3 only

(d) 2 and 3 only

Q29. With reference to BESS developments in India (2026):

1. BESS installations grew by 941% in Q1 2026, reaching 4.6 GWh.
2. The PLI-ACC scheme for batteries has an outlay of Rs.18,100 crore targeting 50 GWh.
3. India has pledged Net Zero emissions by 2070, announced at COP26.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 2 and 3 only |
| (c) 1 and 3 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

Q30. With reference to Noida International Airport (Jewar) opened in June 2026, which is/are correct?

1. It is located in Gautam Buddh Nagar district of Uttar Pradesh.
2. It is operated by YIAPL, a consortium led by Zurich Airport International AG.
3. Phase-1 has a design capacity of 12 million passengers annually.

Select the correct answer:

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 1 and 3 only |
| (c) 2 and 3 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

SECTION A-3: CSAT (Aptitude & Reasoning) (10 x 2 = 20 marks | +2 correct, -0.66 wrong)

Select the most appropriate option.

■ Logical Reasoning, Comprehension & Quantitative Aptitude

Q31. A train 300 metres long is running at 90 km/hr. How long will it take to cross a bridge 200 metres long?

- | | |
|----------------|----------------|
| (a) 15 seconds | (b) 20 seconds |
| (c) 25 seconds | (d) 30 seconds |

Q32. In a certain code, 'TELEGRAM' is written as 'SFKFHQZL'. How will 'PLATFORM' be written in the same code?

- | | |
|--------------|--------------|
| (a) OKZSENMQ | (b) OKYSENQL |
| (c) OKZUENMQ | (d) OKYUGNQL |

Q33. If the day before yesterday was Thursday, what day will it be three days after tomorrow?

- | | |
|---------------|--------------|
| (a) Wednesday | (b) Thursday |
| (c) Tuesday | (d) Monday |

Q34. A shopkeeper marks a product 40% above cost price and gives a discount of 20%. What is his profit percentage?

- | | |
|---------|---------|
| (a) 10% | (b) 12% |
| (c) 15% | (d) 20% |

Q35. Read the following passage and answer the question: 'The government's claim that the new policy will benefit farmers is based on projections that assume normal monsoon and stable global prices. However, the policy does not account for the structural issues of fragmented landholdings and lack of cold-chain infrastructure. Without addressing these, the benefits may remain on paper.' What is the main argument of this passage?

(a) The policy will definitely fail because of poor monsoon.

(c) The government's projections are always inaccurate.

(b) The policy's success depends on structural reforms that it does not address.

(d) Farmers will not benefit because global prices are unstable.

Q36. Three pipes A, B, and C can fill a tank in 6, 8, and 12 hours respectively. If all three are opened together, how long will it take to fill the tank?

(a) 2 hours 40 minutes

(c) 2 hours

(b) 3 hours

(d) 3 hours 20 minutes

Q37. Statement: All students who study daily pass the exam. Rahul did not pass the exam. Conclusion I: Rahul did not study daily. Conclusion II: Rahul is not a student. Which of the conclusions logically follows?

(a) Only Conclusion I follows

(c) Both Conclusions follow

(b) Only Conclusion II follows

(d) Neither Conclusion follows

Q38. The average age of a committee of 8 members is 40 years. A member aged 55 years resigned and a new member aged 39 years joined. What is the new average age?

(a) 38 years

(c) 37 years

(b) 39 years

(d) 36 years

Q39. In a row of children, Amit is 15th from the left and Sumit is 7th from the right. If they interchange positions, Amit becomes 25th from the left. How many children are in the row?

(a) 31

(c) 29

(b) 32

(d) 30

Q40. A farmer has a field shaped as a trapezium with parallel sides of 30 m and 20 m, and perpendicular distance between them of 14 m. What is the area?

(a) 350 sq m

(c) 300 sq m

(b) 420 sq m

(d) 700 sq m

SECTION B: MAINS (10 Marks each - Attempt any ONE) (1 x 10 = 10 marks)

Answer any ONE of the following questions in approximately 150 words.

- Q4** 1. Examine the challenges posed by the growing trend of political defections and party mergers to India's parliamentary democracy. How far has the Anti-Defection Law (Tenth Schedule) succeeded in curbing this practice? Discuss with reference to the 91st Amendment and recent political developments.

[GS-II: Polity] | 10 marks | ~150 words

- Q4** 2. Discuss the significance of the transition from Wholesale Price Index (WPI) to Producer Price Index (PPI) in India. How does PPI better capture inflation dynamics? What challenges might India face in this transition?

[GS-III: Economy] | 10 marks | ~150 words

SECTION C: MAINS (20 Marks each - Attempt any ONE) (1 x 20 = 20 marks)

Answer any ONE of the following questions in approximately 250 words.

- Q4** 3. India's renewable energy ambitions face a critical bottleneck - over 50 GW of capacity remains stranded due to inadequate transmission infrastructure. Analyse the causes of this grid bottleneck, its implications for India's Net Zero 2070 target, and suggest a multi-pronged strategy to resolve it. Include reference to BESS, advanced conductors, and the role of public-private partnerships.

[GS-III: Environment & Energy] | 20 marks | ~250 words

- Q4** 4. 'The Iran-US agreement of June 2026 represents a paradigm shift in West Asian geopolitics.' Critically analyse this statement in the context of the nuclear non-proliferation regime, the role of mediators (Pakistan and Qatar), India's energy security interests, and the broader implications for the Strait of Hormuz and global oil markets.

[GS-II: International Relations] | 20 marks | ~250 words

SECTION D: ESSAY (Attempt any ONE) (1 x 25 = 25 marks)

Write an essay on any ONE of the following topics in 1000-1200 words.

- Q4** 5. 'Technology is a useful servant but a dangerous master.' - In the age of AI-driven governance, platform bans, and algorithmic decision-making, examine the tension between technological efficiency and democratic freedoms.

Essay | 25 marks | 1000-1200 words

- Q4** 6. 'The strength of a democracy lies not in the rigidity of its institutions but in their capacity for self-correction.' - Discuss with reference to the evolving nature of India's Anti-Defection Law, judicial activism, and electoral reforms.

Essay | 25 marks | 1000-1200 words

— END OF QUESTION PAPER —

Total: 165 Marks | UPSC Practice Paper | Copilot CLI UPSC Agent